

Satan Comes to Steal the Word of God Out of You

Mark 4:1 says:

And he began again to teach by the sea side:
and there was gathered unto him a great multitude,
so that he entered into a ship,
and sat in the sea;
and the whole multitude was by the sea on the land.
And he taught them many things by parables,
and said unto them in his doctrine,
Hearken;
Behold, there went out a sower to sow:
And it came to pass, as he sowed,
some fell by the way side,
and the fowls of the air came and devoured it up.
And some fell on stony ground,
where it had not much earth;
and immediately it sprang up,
because it had no depth of earth:
But when the sun was up,
it was scorched;
and because it had no root,
it withered away.
And some fell among thorns,
and the thorns grew up,
and choked it,
and it yielded no fruit.
And other fell on good ground,
and did yield fruit that sprang up and increased;
and brought forth,
some thirty,
and some sixty,
and some an hundred.

Good ground. Good ground.

I have always been a spiritual hog. I always wanted the hundredfold.

Then verse 9 says:

He that hath ears to hear,
let him hear.

In other words, he who has spiritual ears to understand, let him hear.

When He was alone, those who were about Him with the twelve asked Him about the parable.

He said:

Unto you it is given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God:
but unto them that are without,
all these things are done in parables:
That seeing they may see,
and not perceive;
and hearing they may hear,
and not understand;
lest at any time they should be converted,
and their sins should be forgiven them.

What an unusual statement. It sounds as though He does not want them to understand what He is preaching so they can be converted. How many of you have ever passed over that verse? I mean really passed over it.

Thank God for the laws of meditation. If you want to pause long enough to understand this verse before we begin unmasking the devil, we can.

The first thing I found out through the laws of meditation was that when He said, "lest their sins be forgiven them," in the Greek breakdown that word is singular. It is not plural. It is, "lest their sin be forgiven them, and they be converted."

I thought, "Lord, what in the world are You talking about?"

Thank God for the laws of meditation, which say do not take a verse out of context. I had to back up to Mark 3:20:

And the multitude cometh together again,
so that they could not so much as eat bread.
And when his friends heard of it,
they went out to lay hold on him:
for they said,
He is beside himself.

The word "friends" breaks down in the Greek to mean kinsmen. These were relatives of Jesus' natural mother and father. When they heard about the crowd pressing in so tightly that nobody could even eat, and the miracles just before that, especially the casting out of devils, His relatives came and said, "He is beside Himself."

They wanted to take Him away. If you want to know what they wanted to do with Him, they wanted to put Him in an institution. That is what "beside Himself" means. His relatives thought He was mad.

Then the scribes jumped in:

And the scribes which came down from Jerusalem said,
He hath Beelzebub,
and by the prince of the devils casteth he out devils.

Can you imagine a religious group getting so far from God that the Holy Spirit is working precious miracles and casting out devils, and they say He is empowered by an unclean spirit?

Later in the chapter, Jesus says they are bordering on the unpardonable sin. To blaspheme the Holy Spirit is to be in danger of eternal damnation. Their hearts became harder and harder until judgment was brought against them.

When the scribes and Pharisees gathered to contend with Jesus, He spoke the mysteries of God in parables because it was hidden from them. Judgment had been brought against them, lest they listen, be converted, and their sin be forgiven, the very sin of blaspheming what the Holy Spirit was doing.

Go back to Mark 4. In verse 12, He says:

That seeing they may see,
and not perceive;
and hearing they may hear,
and not understand;
lest at any time they should be converted,
and their sin should be forgiven them.

Then He said:

Know ye not this parable?
and how then will ye know all parables?

In other words, "I am going to expound on this, but if you did not understand it in the form of the parable, then what basis do you have to understand any other parable I taught?"

This parable expounds in minute detail the sower, the Word going forth, and its potential to produce up to a hundredfold. It uncovers the enemy's tactics and shows how the Word grows in us, how it functions, and how it operates.

When He says, "Do you not understand this parable? How then will you know all parables?" He is saying that if you do not understand how the Word operates, you have no basis to understand any other parable He taught.

That gets me excited. It means if I meditate long enough and the Spirit thoroughly makes me understand this parable, then the Spirit will set a precedent in me for every other parable Jesus taught.

Jesus gives the subject in verse 14:

The sower soweth the word.

That is the subject. The sower sows the Word.

Every parable has an objective. The objective of this parable is how to guard against these tools of Satan and produce a hundredfold based on the Word of God.

A parable is something I can understand with my natural mind. I understand what a sower is. I know what seed is. I know how a seed operates. A parable uses something I can understand naturally to illustrate a spiritual application. The application is the objective.

This parable's objective is how to unmask Satan, how to guard against these things, and how to turn a hundredfold based on the Word of God.

Verse 15 says:

And these are they by the way side,
where the word is sown;
but when they have heard,
Satan cometh immediately,
and taketh away the word that was sown in their hearts.

Satan comes immediately, before the service is over.

What an insult. All the time I thought he was harassing me because he did not want me to have the new car. No, he was not harassing me over the car. He did not care whether I had a new car or not.

In fact, if you enter into lust and the deceitfulness of riches and start departing from the Word, he will give you six of them. That is not what he is after. He is after the thing sown in you, the Word of God that would produce the new car.

I know a lot of you have trouble when the next part talks about persecutions and afflictions. You think Satan has a personal vendetta against you. To tell you the truth, he could care less about you. He does not have a personal vendetta against you.

The only thing he wants to remove out of you is the Word of God that has been sown there.

Contrary to a lot of our thinking, we are not something special because he launched an attack against us. Peter says:

Think it not strange concerning the fiery trial which is to try you,
as though some strange thing happened unto you.

How many of you really think your case is special? "My God, this is strange. This is a strange thing that happened."

He said do not think it strange.

Satan is not after my accomplished singing voice. He is not after me as a person. He is after the one thing sown into my heart that will make the difference in all this damnable stuff he brings against me.

Do not flatter yourself. He is after one thing: to remove the Word of God long before it threatens to produce a sixtyfold or hundredfold return. He knows the longer he leaves the Word of God inside you, the more danger it runs of taking root. If it takes root, then he is in danger of it producing.

It is not you he is afraid of. He is afraid of the Word of God, because it is the authority, the power, the doctrine, and the life. He knows that if you ever get an operating knowledge of the Word of God, you are in danger of pulling that two-edged sword and slicing him down the middle from the top of his head to the bottom of his heels.

He cannot afford to run that risk.

Verse 16 says:

And these are they likewise which are sown on stony ground;
who, when they have heard the word,
immediately receive it with gladness;
And have no root in themselves,
and so endure but for a time:
afterward,
when affliction or persecution ariseth for the word's sake,
immediately they are offended.

If you do not mind underlining the word "likewise," underline it. "Likewise" means these are people also into whom the Word of God was sown. They are like the first. Satan comes to steal the Word out of them too, but now Jesus begins uncovering the tools he hides behind to do it.

The devil is so clever, hiding behind his mask, that when persecutions and afflictions arise for the Word's sake, we blame them on everything else. We blame our job, our dog, our family, our finances. "If I were not married and had six children, I could go full-time."

Who we do not blame is the hypocrite hiding behind the mask: Satan.

It does not matter, as far as persecution is concerned, if you are in Siberia at the bottom of a coal mine, a prisoner of the Communist empire, and they stand over you with a whip all day persecuting you. That persecution came on you for one reason: to remove the Word of God before it can take root in you and produce.

I do not mind telling you, that made me bear down harder and harder on the Word of God.

Once again, what is the subject of this parable?

The sower soweth the word.

The objective is to produce a hundredfold walking on it.

Then verse 21 says:

Is a candle brought to be put under a bushel,
or under a bed?
and not to be set on a candlestick?

If the subject is the Word of God, then He is saying: Is the understanding of the Word given to you not to understand? Is the Word given to be hidden under a bushel so the light is blocked?

What is the purpose of bringing a candle into a room? Once you set the lamp on the lampstand and light it, you can see every hidden obstacle in that room.

What is the Word of God given to you for? Not to understand? Or has He promised that the Word of God is illumination, revelation knowledge, the light you need to walk by? It will uncover everything hidden in darkness, every area of your life where you are void of understanding, until you can walk in a hundredfold.

When Satan moves in with his attack, what is the Word given to you for? To light you, to supply all the light you need to walk by. The entrance of His Word brings light.

Let me ask you something. When Jesus sat down at the right hand of the Father after His ascension, concerning the cross, redemption of mankind, and all the tools we needed to walk victorious, do you think He forgot anything?

Do you think He left anything unturned? When redemption concerning you and me, concerning this whole dispensation of grace, was declared finished, do you believe there was one stone left unturned?

Or do you believe that when He sat down at the right hand of the Father, He made available every possible tool and weapon you and I could ever need to walk in ultimate victory on this earth?

Yes, He did.

In this revelation to you and me, Matthew, Mark, Luke, John, the epistles, the book of Revelation, all of it contains the light, the revelation knowledge we walk by. That is what Satan is so deathly fearful of, and he will remove it out of you at any cost.

The most ingenious cloak he uses is religion. To a religious person, he has to use religion. He would not step in with horns and a tail and tell you God does not exist. But he will step in just like he did with the Pharisees and give you an alternate, an alternative.

Where do you think religion came from?

When I found out by revelation that Jesus took my infirmities, bore my sicknesses, carried my pains, and took all my afflictions, religion had taught me for many years that it was God's will to heal some and not others.

That is not true, but it is an alternative. Satan certainly could not tell me God did not heal. I was already past that. He had to neutralize me on a higher plane, and brother, he did. He neutralized my elders, and we were both neutralized.

When I found out the truth, more than once I took my bold stand on the Word of God. About the time you open your big mouth and say, "I believe He bore my sicknesses and carried my pains," Satan is over there snickering, "We will see about that."

The deal is on.

You feel good and start saying it. Then pretty soon, you get something you never had before.

"Oh my God."

You confess the Word and stomp back and forth.

"I said I believe I received."

Then everybody says, "Joined the flakes. He used to be sound in doctrine. He believed God healed some and not others. Now look at him. He is with the flakes, marching around proclaiming things like that."

You wage the war for a while, and after Satan wears you down and you are as sick as you have ever been, he starts talking to you:

"Have you ever thought that maybe you are in error?"

Your finances hit a new low. When you were a sinner, you prospered. Your business did well. Then you got born again and said, "I am going to give millions to the gospel."

"We will see about that."

The deal is on. You have never had it so bad. Now you cannot lie and cheat on your income tax. Everything you do is stacked against you. It gets crucial. If he can destroy your root, he will destroy it.

What it finally boils down to is the one who digs his heels into the rock of the Word and says, "Hell or high water, rainstorm, let God be true and every man a liar. My personal circumstances have nothing to do with the eternal settlement of God's Word. If I die standing here, let it be reported in the regions of the damned that I was healed because the Word of God says I was. You are not taking it out of me."

Then you are on your way.

Why do you think I keep preaching so hard on praying in tongues? You speak divine secrets and mysteries so the Word of God can get on the inside of your spirit, where the candle is lit.

Our weapons are mighty through God. They are not carnal. They are not according to the flesh. Some of us fight the battle in our own strength, in such turmoil, unrest, and striving, almost against ourselves.

Why do you think He put the Holy Spirit in you?

The Word of God has always been there as far as you are concerned. The finest theological minds in the world have contemplated it, meditated on it, and written books on it. Great institutions have been born. People memorize the whole thing and are not even filled with the Holy Ghost.

The Word of God has been there. It is the candlestick. But guess what the fire is on it?

What do we need the Spirit for?

The man who prays in tongues has the most valuable means to communicate the divine secrets and mysteries in fellowship with God. That causes the candle to be lit. It causes the Word to be understood.

That is when the devil comes to you and says, "It is not."

Then you can turn and boldly declare, "Oh yes, it is," not because you are trying to talk yourself into it, but because you are simply reporting outwardly what you possess in your spirit. Your candle has been lit.

Is a candle lit to be hidden under a bushel? No. It was designed to sit on a candlestick, so you can walk by the light of it.

I am confident that concerning redemption, Jesus has done everything pertaining to Dave Roberson that could ever possibly need to be done.

Verse 22 says:

For there is nothing hid,
which shall not be manifested;
neither was any thing kept secret,
but that it should come abroad.

Every mystery hidden in God concerning redemption is available to be manifested to you. There is not a divine secret in the entire Word of God that is not available to come abroad.

That is what the Word of God is given to you for. That is why He said:

If any man have ears to hear,
let him hear.

I remember when I started prospering in God. I had always been a spiritual hog. I think it was my hunger, even when I was in ultra-holiness believing every doctrine that came down the road, that drove me to thirst after righteousness until He filled me time after time.

It seems I would win victories and walk on one plane, thinking, "Boy, it is comfortable operating in my comfortable faith zone."

About that time He would say, "Look up, Roberson."

"What?"

"Look up. See that mountain?"

"Yes."

"Move it."

"But I like it here."

"Move it."

The problem is that when we reject the moving of the mountain to go on, it is hard to hold the ground we have.

I felt in my spirit that God wanted me to increase my operating expenses, to believe for several thousand dollars a month to spread the gospel, instead of what I was spreading it on. I knew I was not really ready for it. I was driving down the street in my fourteen-thousand-dollar motor home, paid for.

I was worshiping God and felt close to Him. I cried, "If I just had this amount of money, I could spread the gospel."

He said, "You have got it."

Then everything that was hidden, not only in my life but in the Word of God, everything I had not understood that was keeping me from walking in it, became available. When I made my faith declaration, immediately the Holy Spirit went to work with the additional illumination and everything I needed to walk there.

He uncovered something in me that was hidden. He said, "Give your motor home away."

Every little inch in me rebelled.

He said, "Give it away."

It rebelled.

"You are the one who asked for the five thousand-dollar monthly increase. I did not."

He said, "Get rid of it."

He did not want my motor home. He wanted the Word to illuminate and remove the thing within me that was keeping me from receiving the five thousand.

I did not want to be deceived by riches anyway.

He said there is nothing covered that will not be brought to light. There is nothing hidden that is not available to be illuminated in you. Anything you could possibly need to walk in the hundredfold, God has given you a personal guarantee that it is available to you.

Verse 24 says:

And he said unto them,
Take heed what ye hear:
with what measure ye mete,
it shall be measured to you:
and unto you that hear shall more be given.

What is the subject of this teaching? The sower sows the Word.

He says, "Take heed what you hear." You are the one who is supposed to put the guard on what you hear. With what measure of the Word you measure out to use, it will be measured to you.

Whether you measure out thirty, sixty, or a hundredfold, whatever measure you measure out is what comes back to you. If you are operating in thirtyfold, then you are seventy percent shy. You could have the rest if you wanted it. If you are operating in sixtyfold, you are forty percent shy, and you could have that if you wanted it.

He said to take heed what you hear, because the measure you measure out to operate in is simply what you will receive.

"I just do not really believe in talking in tongues."

Then measure thirtyfold out. Go ahead. God will be the last One to shove it down your throat.

"I do not believe healing is for everybody."

Then do not measure it out. You will be one who never gets it.

The measure I measure out to use will be measured to me again.

"Maybe I believe that other stuff, but to believe Jesus bore my poverty for the purpose of making me rich, giving me His standing..."

We go on to think carnally. "I want to be filthy rich." But if you are that kind of steward, there is no limit to what you can do for the kingdom of God. That is why He made it available.

The devil neutralizes most of us because we would rather believe that being poor is being humble than believe God wants to make us rich for the kingdom of God's sake.

"You may preach all that stuff, Roberson, but I will not believe it."

Nobody will ever make you. The measure you measure out to operate in is exactly what you are going to get.

There are whole denominations the devil is cloaked in and hiding behind, and he has stripped tongues from them. They are good folks, born-again, godly-living people. But if you mention tongues to them, they will take your head off.

God loves them, but they measured that measure out, and God will not impose it on them. He just will not do it. That is God.

On the other hand, if you measure out a hundred and say, "I want it all," then He said nothing will be hidden that He will not uncover to make sure you get it.

I love it.